3.4 Acequias and Mission Farming

4th Grade Social Studies · Video: Acequias, Aqueducts, and Agriculture (San Antonio Missions NHP (MissionsNPS))

Name: _____ Date: _____

Watch the video and fill in the blanks as you go.

Water Is a Basic Need

Basic human needs like _____ and food are essential for life.

So the Spanish built water works such as _____, aqueducts, and acequias.

The Alamo's Acequia

On May 1, _____, Father Antonio de San Buenaventura y Olivares founded Mission San Antonio de Valero.

Mission San Antonio de Valero is better known as the _____.

The mission was completed with an _____, or irrigation ditch.

It was one of the first acequias in San Antonio.

This acequia was named the _____ de Valero.

The Espada Aqueduct

The Espada Aqueduct was built in the _____.

It is still serving the _____ today.

Farming with Irrigation

Irrigating the land created over _____ of farmland near the missions.

A mission dam and acequia in the park still help grow food for the San Antonio _____.

The city of San Antonio still uses water methods that were created _____ of years ago.

Think about it: What actions can you take to _____ water?

Vocabulary

Word	Meaning
acequia	an _____ ditch that carries water to fields
aqueduct	a channel or bridge that carries water over land or a creek
dam	a wall that holds back or raises the water in a river
conserve	to use something carefully so it is not wasted

Key Takeaways

• The Spanish missions built dams, acequias, and aqueducts to bring water to their fields.

• Irrigation turned over 3,500 acres near the missions into farmland.

• Some of these water works, like the Espada Aqueduct, are still used today.